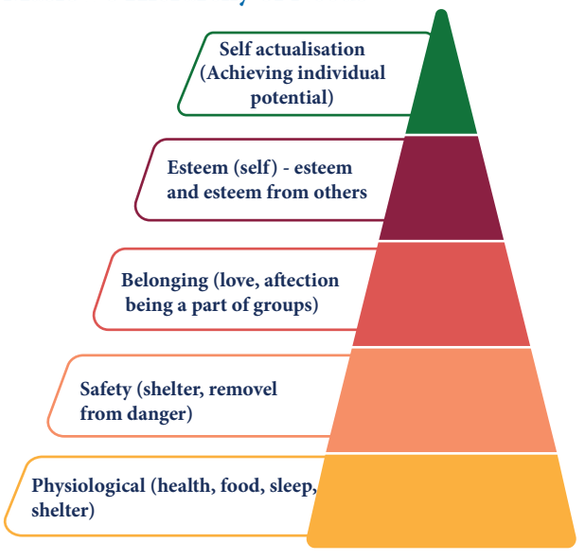
first four levels of the pyramid contains "deficiency needs" such as physiological, safety, love/belonging and esteem needs. The basic needs must be met before the individual will strongly desire for the next level needs. For example, an individual will not expect safety needs until unless his physiological needs are met. He will not desire for love and belonging before the safety needs are met. Maslow also coined the term 'meta motivation' to describe the motivation of people who go beyond the scope of the basic needs and strive for constant betterment. If these "deficiency needs" are not met, the individual will feel anxious and tense.

Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs



Physiological needs

Physiological needs are the physical requirements for human survival. If these requirements are not met, the human body cannot function properly and will ultimately fail. Physiological needs are the first and basic need in the hierarchy. Without them, the other needs cannot follow up. Physiological needs include breathing, water, food, sleep, clothing, shelter and sex.

Safety needs

Once a person's physiological needs are relatively satisfied, their safety needs take precedence and dominate behavior. For example in the absence of physical safety – due to war, natural disaster etc. – people may experience stress and tension. Safety and Security needs include personal security, emotional security, financial security, health and well being and safety needs against accidents/illness and their adverse impacts.

Love/Belonging

The third level of human needs is interpersonal and involves feelings of belongingness. Social Belonging needs include friendships, family and intimacy. Human beings need to feel a sense of belonging and acceptance among social groups, regardless whether these groups are large or small. The example for large social groups may include clubs, religious groups, sports teams, gangs, etc and some small social connections include family members, intimate partners, mentors, colleagues, etc. Human beings need to love and be loved – both sexually and non-sexually – by others.

Self esteem

Self Esteem is a belief about one's own worth based on an overall self evaluation. Esteem needs are ego needs or status needs which are related to getting recognition, status, importance, and respect from others in the society. All humans have a need to feel respected; this includes the need to have self esteem and self-respect. These activities give the person a sense of contribution or value. Deficiency in this level leads to low self esteem.

How people with low and high self esteem view themselves?

Those with low self esteem tend to view themselves in negative terms. They do not feel good about them, tend to have trouble in dealing effectively with others and are hampered by self doubts. High self esteem individuals, in contrast, see themselves as worthwhile, capable and acceptable.

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